diplomatic indicators before we can fully assess or conclude on significant policy changes. Examining these different facets of India's China policy, our study will further the insight into changes and variations in India's China policy and in which direction India's China policy is heading.

Level of analysis

A state's foreign policy behaviour is mainly shaped by variables at three levels: the distribution of power in the international system, through institutions and structures at the domestic level, and by the perceptions and ambitions of state leaders.[64] As introduced earlier in this chapter, polarity and the number of great powers in the international system strongly inform state behaviour, and recent developments in this regard point in the direction of India balancing China. Assessing how India manages China's rise, it is nevertheless also important to take into account that the explanation for India's recent pro-active foreign policy may not only be found at the structural level in the form of China's growing power but also in India's own growth and increased ambitions in South Asia and beyond. We should also look at how domestic politics and Modi's personal leadership have informed India's policy towards China.

When the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) led by Narendra Modi won the 2014 elections, it not only broke records in terms of levels of voter participation but marked a break from the previous 30 years of India's electoral history with a single party, the BJP, achieving a parliamentary majority on its own for the first time since 1984, without depending on coalition partners.[65] When Modi was re-elected as Prime Minister in 2019 for another five years, the BJP gained 21 more seats in the *Lok Sabha*, the lower house of the Indian Parliament. Along with its allies, the BJP-led National Democratic Alliance (NDA) now has 350 parliamentarians in